INTUITION_OS_MASTER_SPEC.md

PART 1

PRODUCT FOUNDATION

VISION · PHILOSOPHY · USERS · PROBLEM DEFINITION

Version: 1.0

Status: Source of Truth

Executive Summary

Intuition OS is a learning intelligence platform designed to help problem solvers develop intuition rather than dependency.

The platform observes how users think while solving coding problems, identifies behavioral patterns, tracks growth over time, and provides personalized mentorship designed to improve independent problem-solving ability.

Unlike traditional coding platforms which focus on outcomes such as accepted submissions, Intuition OS focuses on understanding and improving the process that leads to those outcomes.

The objective is not to help users solve the current problem.

The objective is to help users become capable of solving similar problems independently in the future.

Problem Statement

Current learning platforms optimize for outcomes.

Examples:

- Accepted solutions
- Problems solved

- Contest ratings
- Streaks
- Completion metrics

These metrics reveal little about how a person thinks.

Current AI assistants have a different issue.

They optimize for immediate success.

Workflow:

Problem → Ask AI → Receive Hint → Receive Solution → Finish Problem

This often creates a feeling of artificial progress.

Users solve problems but fail to develop intuition.

Over time users become dependent on assistance rather than developing independent reasoning ability.

The market lacks a system capable of:

- Understanding how users think
- Tracking learning behavior
- Identifying recurring weaknesses
- Measuring intuition growth
- Providing personalized mentorship

This is the gap Intuition OS addresses.

Core Thesis

The most valuable learning signal is not:

"Did the user solve the problem?"

The most valuable learning signal is:

"How did the user approach the problem?"

Examples:

User A:

- Solved independently
- No hints
- Correct pattern identified

User B:

- Viewed editorial
- Followed solution
- Solved successfully

Traditional systems treat both outcomes equally.

Intuition OS does not.

The platform values reasoning quality over completion.

Vision

Build the operating system for becoming a better problem solver.

The platform should eventually become capable of answering:

- What are my strengths?
- What are my weaknesses?
- Why am I stuck?
- How am I improving?
- What should I learn next?

The system should understand the user's growth journey better than any coding platform currently available.

Long-Term Vision

Current AI tools remember conversations.

Intuition OS remembers growth.

The platform should become a long-term mentor that accumulates understanding over hundreds of learning sessions.

Over time it should know:

- Which concepts a user struggles with
- Which patterns a user recognizes
- Which mistakes repeat
- Which behaviors improve
- Which interventions work

The mentor should become increasingly personalized.

Product Philosophy

The philosophy of Intuition OS is defined by five principles.

Principle 1

Build Intuition, Not Dependency

The platform exists to reduce future dependence on assistance.

Every interaction should improve independent thinking.

The ideal outcome is that users require less help over time.

Principle 2

Ask Before Telling

Diagnosis precedes guidance.

The mentor should first understand:

- What the user tried
- What the user believes
- Why the user is stuck

before offering assistance.

Principle 3

Evidence Before Conclusions

The platform should never make unsupported claims.

Bad:

"You are resilient."

Good:

"You continued solving after four failed submissions."

Evidence must always precede interpretation.

Principle 4

Progress Over Problem Counts

The platform values:

- Pattern recognition
- Optimization ability
- Debugging skill
- Independence
- Recovery ability

more than:

- Problems solved
- Streaks
- Badges

Principle 5

The Mentor Remembers

Every session contributes to learning memory.

The mentor should continuously improve its understanding of the user.

Product Positioning

The platform is NOT:

- LeetCode clone
- Competitive programming platform
- AI coding assistant
- Code generation tool
- Online IDE

The platform IS:

A personalized problem-solving mentor.

Target Users

Primary Audience:

1. Interview Preparation Students
2. LeetCode Users
3. Competitive Programmers
4. Intermediate DSA Learners

Non Target Audience (V1)

Do not optimize for:

- Complete beginners
- Users learning variables
- Users learning loops
- Introductory programming education

The platform is intended for users already solving problems.

User Personas

Persona A

Interview Candidate

Goals:

- Pass coding interviews
- Improve DSA
- Understand weaknesses

Frustrations:

- Repeatedly viewing solutions
- Not knowing why progress stalls
- Difficulty measuring improvement

Persona B

LeetCode Grinder

Goals:

- Improve efficiency
- Solve harder problems
- Build intuition

Frustrations:

- Generic AI hints
- Lack of personalized guidance
- Difficulty identifying bottlenecks

Persona C

Competitive Programmer

Goals:

- Improve rating
- Recognize patterns faster
- Improve problem-solving speed

Frustrations:

- Weak pattern recognition
- Repeated mistakes
- Plateauing performance

Core User Insight

Users do not primarily want answers.

Users want confidence.

Specifically:

Confidence that they can solve similar problems independently in the future.

The mentor should optimize for confidence through competence.

Not confidence through encouragement.

Why Existing AI Tools Fail

ChatGPT:

Strengths:

- Great explanations
- Great code generation

Weaknesses:

- No learning memory
- No behavioral understanding
- No personalization
- Encourages dependency

Claude:

Similar limitations.

Cursor:

Focuses on implementation.

Not learning.

LeetCode AI:

Focuses on solution generation.

Not intuition development.

Core Differentiator

ChatGPT knows:

The current problem.

Intuition OS knows:

The current learner.

This distinction defines the entire product.

Product Outcome

Success is not:

The user solved more problems.

Success is:

The user required less help over time while solving increasingly difficult problems.

North Star Metric

Independent Problem Solving Growth

Proxy signals:

- Hint dependency reduction
- Editorial dependency reduction
- Pattern recognition improvement
- Recovery ability improvement
- Optimization intuition improvement

These metrics matter more than acceptance rate.

Product Identity

If someone asks:

"What is Intuition OS?"

The answer should be:

"A personal mentor that helps problem solvers develop intuition through guided reasoning, behavioral feedback, and long-term learning memory."

Not:

"An AI that gives coding hints."

That positioning is critically important.

END OF PART 1